



Tips & Tricks



How to get to a particular port on a remote server

The *netcat* command is handy.

```
netcat -w 3 -z -vvn 64.233.187.99 79-81
(UNKNOWN) [64.233.187.99] 81 (?): Connection timed out
(UNKNOWN) [64.233.187.99] 80 (www): open
(UNKNOWN) [64.233.187.99] 79 (finger): Connection timed out
```

This example essentially runs a port scan on *google.com* from Port 79 to 81, and waits for 3 seconds for a port to time out. You can see that only port 80 is open. I use this constantly when troubleshooting connections between application servers and databases, especially when firewalls are involved.

This is much more meaningful than a simple *ping*. Note that *netcat* only accepts IP addresses, not host names, so you can ping a host first to get its IP address first. Also note that port scans may violate your own network policies and could be construed as a form of hacking, so use at your own risk and tell someone what you're going to do before you do it. You can install *netcat* on Windows using Cygwin (the command is *nc* in Cygwin).

—Ajeet Singh Raina, ajeetraina@gmail.com



Sort folders by size

To sort folders by size, use the following command:

```
du --max-depth=1 /home/ | sort -n -r
```

—Ajeet Singh Raina, ajeetraina@gmail.com



How to indent programs properly

Would you like to indent your C or Perl code properly?

If so, for Perl use *perltidy* as shown below. It can be

downloaded from CPAN:

```
<your_perlide.pl>
```

The output will be saved in the *<your_perlide.pltidy>* file. For C programs, use GNUIndent, as indicated below:

```
indent <your_c_code.c>
```

That's all! Now *<your_c_code.c>* will be indented properly. There's no 'tidy' for Python because you in any case write tidy beautiful Python code.

—Jaganadh G, jaganadhg@gmail.com



Is my file defragmented?

If we want to know how badly a file is fragmented in ext2/ext3 in Linux, there is a utility called *filefrag*. It makes allowances for indirect blocks for ext2 and ext3 filesystems. Syntax: *filefrag <filename>*. For example:

```
# filefrag list.sh
list.sh: 1 extent found
# filefrag -v list.sh
filefrag -v list.sh
Checking list.sh
Filesystem type is: ef53
Filesystem cylinder groups is approximately 237
Blocksize of file list.sh is 4096
File size of list.sh is 15275 (4 blocks)
First block: 143526
Last block: 143529
list.sh: 1 extent found
```

Use the *-v* option for the verbose mode to see the complete blocks list.



Note: 1. To execute the *filefrag* you need to be the super-user.